

Scenario: Customer tries to transfer ₹50,000. Transaction failed. Error shown: "Transaction could not be completed." Act as a Senior Banking Support Investigator [Mandatory] Let's think step by step to identify the root cause of the failure.

As a Senior Banking Support Investigator, I would perform a structured investigation by validating each layer involved in the transaction. The generic error message, **"Transaction could not be completed,"** does not identify the actual cause, so the investigation should systematically eliminate possible failures.

Step 1: Gather Transaction Details

Collect the following information before starting the investigation:

- Transaction ID (if generated)
- Date and Time of transaction
- Customer ID/Account Number
- Source Account
- Beneficiary Account
- Transfer Type (IMPS/NEFT/RTGS/UPI/Internal Transfer)
- Transfer Amount (₹50,000)
- Channel used (Mobile App, Internet Banking, Branch, API)
- Error code (if available in backend logs)
- Device/Browser/App version
- Customer's location/IP address

Expected Outcome:

- Confirm whether the transaction request actually reached the banking system.
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Step 2: Verify Customer Account

Check:

- Is the account active?
- Is the account frozen?
- Is there a debit block?

- Is KYC valid?
- Is the account closed?

Possible Root Cause

Validation	Result
Account Frozen	Transaction rejected
Debit Freeze	Debit not permitted
KYC Expired	Regulatory restriction
Dormant Account	Debit blocked

Step 3: Verify Available Balance

Check

Available Balance

-

Lien Amount

-

Minimum Balance Requirement

Example

Available Balance

₹52,000

Minimum Balance

₹5,000

Transfer

₹50,000

Remaining

₹2,000

Since minimum balance is violated,

Root Cause

Insufficient withdrawable balance.

Step 4: Verify Transaction Limits

Check configured limits.

Examples:

- Daily Transfer Limit
- Per Transaction Limit
- Monthly Limit
- Beneficiary Limit

Example

Customer Daily Limit

₹25,000

Attempted

₹50,000

Result

Transaction rejected.

Step 5: Verify Beneficiary

Validate

- Beneficiary exists
- Account number correct
- IFSC valid
- Beneficiary activated
- Cooling period completed

Possible issue

Beneficiary added recently.

Cooling period

24 Hours

Transfer attempted immediately.

System blocks transaction.

Step 6: Verify Fraud/Risk Engine

Risk engine may block the transaction.

Check

- Velocity rules
- Unusual location
- Device mismatch
- High-value transfer
- AML rules
- Sanctions screening

Possible scenario

Customer usually transfers

₹5,000

Suddenly

₹50,000

Fraud engine flags transaction.

Step 7: Verify Authentication

Check

- OTP validated
- Transaction PIN
- MPIN
- Biometric
- Session timeout

Possible failures

- OTP expired

- Wrong OTP
 - Token expired
 - Session timeout
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Step 8: Verify Payment Switch

Check whether request reached

- IMPS Switch
- NEFT Gateway
- RTGS Gateway
- UPI Switch

Possible issues

- Switch unavailable
 - Network timeout
 - Queue overflow
 - Host unavailable
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Step 9: Verify Core Banking System (CBS)

Check CBS logs.

Possible failures

- Debit posting failure
 - Database timeout
 - Lock timeout
 - Ledger unavailable
 - CBS maintenance
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Step 10: Verify Database

Check

- Deadlocks

- Connection pool exhaustion
- Transaction rollback
- Commit failure

Example

Debit Successful

Credit Failed

Rollback Executed

Step 11: Verify Network Infrastructure

Investigate

- API Gateway
- Firewall
- Load Balancer
- DNS
- VPN
- Internal Network

Possible issues

- Packet loss
- High latency
- Gateway timeout

Step 12: Verify Application Logs

Review logs for:

- Exception stack traces
- HTTP status codes
- Internal error codes

- Correlation IDs
- Timeout events

Example

HTTP 504

Gateway Timeout

or

CBS_CONNECTION_TIMEOUT

Step 13: Verify Third-Party Dependencies

If applicable, verify

- NPCI connectivity
- Payment gateway availability
- SMS gateway (OTP delivery)
- Authentication service
- Notification service

Step 14: Verify Reconciliation Status

Determine whether

- Debit happened?
- Credit happened?
- Transaction pending?
- Auto reversal initiated?

Possible scenarios

Debit	Credit	Status
No	No	Failed
Yes	Yes	Success
Yes	No	Reversal Required

Debit Credit Status

Yes Pending Await Reconciliation

Step 15: Review Monitoring Alerts

Check dashboards for

- Server CPU
- Memory utilization
- Database health
- Queue backlog
- API latency
- Payment switch alerts

Likely Root Causes

Category	Example Root Cause
Customer	Insufficient available balance
Customer	Daily transfer limit exceeded
Customer	Beneficiary cooling period
Customer	Invalid OTP
Customer	KYC restriction
Fraud	Risk engine blocked transaction
Network	Gateway timeout
Database	Deadlock or rollback
CBS	Core banking unavailable
Payment Switch	NPCI/NEFT/IMPS switch unavailable
Infrastructure	Server overload
External	Third-party outage

Investigation Flow Summary

Customer Initiates Transfer



Validate Customer Account



Check Available Balance



Check Transaction Limits



Validate Beneficiary



Verify Authentication



Fraud & Risk Assessment



Payment Switch Connectivity



Core Banking Processing





Database Commit



Reconciliation



Determine Root Cause

Recommended Next Actions

1. Check whether a transaction ID and backend error code were generated.
2. Confirm if the source account was debited or if the transaction failed before debit.
3. Review application, payment switch, and CBS logs using the transaction timestamp and correlation ID.
4. Validate account balance, transfer limits, beneficiary status, and authentication logs.
5. If the debit occurred without a corresponding credit, prioritize reconciliation and initiate an auto-reversal or manual recovery according to the bank's operational procedures.